

Database servers

There are some who might not like to call their machine a server. But then at least few must already be aware that even VLC can work as a multimedia server. A database server as such is not something too cool to talk about but can be extremely useful for someone who is either trying to develop his own application (we missed 'web', eh?) or is trying to test out which CMS suits the best. A database server is used in many cases ranging from music catalogs to large scale applications' storage point. There are quite some interesting servers in this category.

- ▶ **MySQL:** If you are a developer or interested in developing almost any type of web application, or even just interested in computing, chances are you have already heard of this immensely popular word. MySQL is used in some of the major companies worldwide. The names would include Yahoo, Google, Amazon, ebay and a few more. The major reasons for using MySQL are speed and availability of different storage engines which can be attached to MySQL at any time. Also, configuring it is quite easy and does not involve much pain. For a developer who loves to carry his laptop around, `/etc/my.cnf`. Of course it takes a whole lot of extra pain than just editing this file for those who want the fully fledged server to run but this is the minimum we could tell you. Look into the manual for more. In case you are a student and are not already using MySQL and are in need of a database which would obey the commands and queries written in your course book, do look over to the next option. We assure you will not be disappointed.
- ▶ **PostgreSQL:** One of the open source databases which stands apart from most others in the free arena. The reason is the standards compliance. PostgreSQL has been designed ground up to remain integrated (unlike MySQL whose functionalities depend on the storage engine in use) and comply to as many SQL standards as possible. While there are a lot of functionalities which are not supported by MySQL, PostgreSQL would not let you down. One of the features which PostgreSQL happily announces is "complete support for foreign keys". Yes, the default engine of MySQL, also known as `myisam` is not in favor of using foreign keys. Moreover, it does not always follow the SQL queries in the way Oracle would. Since most text books are written keeping oracle in mind, it might be a problem for a student who expects MySQL to listen to commands. At times it might be annoying and even frustrating to discover that some basic functionality like the 'check' constraint does not work with MySQL. PostgreSQL on other hand is fine in these regards. Please note that we do not mean to degrade